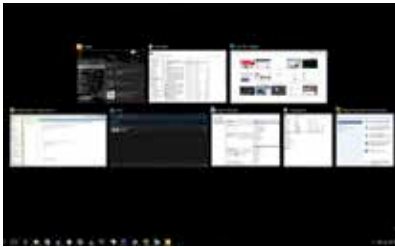


A virtual desktop is a collection of related windows, and you can have multiple such virtual desktops for different tasks. For instance, you could have a virtual desktop with work stuff, a browser window with your work email open, Excel, maybe your documents folder. Another virtual desktop could have a game of chess that you dabble in occasionally, and a third one could be one where you have your personal email open in the browser, and your photos folder open to upload some of them to Facebook.

Now, organising windows like this is not something that is mandated by the OS. You could keep all your browser windows in one desktop and all your explorer windows in another. Or whatever organisation scheme tickles your fancy, or none at all if that's what you prefer.

When you are using the “work” virtual desktop, then the only visible windows are the ones in that virtual desktop, while the others continue running invisibly. On the task bar you only see windows from the current desktop, and when you use Alt-tab, only windows from the current virtual desktop show up.

In Windows 10, this is somewhat configurable though. You can have all windows regardless of which desktop they are on show up in Alt-tab and on the taskbar if you want.



The task view makes it easy to get an overview of open windows even if you're only using a single desktop.

All of this is accessed and managed through a new button on the taskbar that toggles the ‘Task View’. You’ll find that Task View quite similar to the Alt-Tab UI except that it stays open till dismissed. It’s also accessible via [Start+Tab].

Even if you don’t care for virtual desktops, this view lays out all open windows in a grid,

so you have a better look at all your running applications.

You can switch to a window by clicking it or close it by clicking on the ‘X’ that appears above each window when you hover over it. This is a great way to quickly dock multiple windows without needing to switch to each individually.

In this view you will also see a button called ‘New desktop’ that does what you’d expect. On clicking this button, a new bar with all open desktops will appear below the grid of windows. From here you can switch between different desktops.